INSIDE THE INDUSTRY

ALMOST EVERY REASON YOU'VE BEEN GIVEN TO PULL A LISTING OFF THE MLS WAS WRITTEN BY SOMEONE WHO MAKES MONEY WHEN YOU DO.

There are two honest reasons to sell a home in private. Here's both, and why the rest is a story your brokerage needs you to believe.

D.J. Paris
Keeping It Real Podcast

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A STRATEGY THAT PAYS THE HOUSE AND COSTS THE CLIENT IS NOT A STRATEGY.

It's a conflict of interest with better marketing.

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WHEN YOUR LISTING NEVER HITS THE MLS, YOUR OWN BROKERAGE HAS THE BEST SHOT AT THE BUYER TOO.

Same firm, both sides of the commission. That's the engine behind the big private-exclusive programs. It's not a seller feature. It's a revenue stream.

INVENTORY NOBODY ELSE CAN SEE ALSO RECRUITS AGENTS AND PULLS BUYERS TO THE OFFICE.

Every one of those wins goes to the house, not the seller.

THE SELLER HEARS THREE WORDS: PRIVACY, CONTROL, EXCLUSIVITY.

Bright MLS and Drexel studied over a million sales. Homes on the MLS sold for about 17.5% more, roughly $54,000 on a typical sale.

$1 BILLION.

That's Zillow's own estimate of the total seller loss from off-MLS sales. Privacy that quietly costs your seller fifty grand isn't privacy. It's a price cut they never agreed to.

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TWO REASONS ACTUALLY HOLD UP.

One: safety, for anyone whose home address in public is a real risk. Two: a seller who sees the $54,000 number, understands it, and still chooses privacy, documented. Everything else is a handful of luxury deals, not a default.

BEFORE YOU PITCH A PRIVATE LISTING, ASK THIS:

1. Is this for my seller's safety, or my brokerage's spreadsheet?
2. Has my seller actually seen the number: about 17.5% less, roughly $54,000 on a typical sale?
3. If they still want privacy after seeing it, document that choice.
4. If it's not safety and they haven't seen the numbers, you already know the answer.

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THE TAKEAWAY

PULL YOUR LAST PRIVATE-LISTING PITCH. DID YOUR SELLER SEE THE $54,000 NUMBER BEFORE THEY CHOSE, OR AFTER?

A strategy that pays the house and costs the client is not a strategy. It's a conflict of interest with better marketing.

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